coursera | MoMA

Modern Art & Ideas ✕

Today's goal • 3/3 items

Module 1
Introduction to Modern Art & Ideas

Module 2
Places & Spaces

Introduction to Places & Spaces

✓ Welcome to Module 2
Reading • 10 min

✓ Places & Spaces
Video • 4 min

Real and Imaginary Places

✓ How do artists choose to represent the world?
Reading • 20 min

✓ Martin Wong. Stanton near Forsyth Street. 1983
Video • 1 min

✓ Practical Scenario
Real-world application • 5 min

✓ Zarina. Home is a Foreign Place. 1999
Video • 2 min

Experiencing a Place

✓ How do artists capture the mood of a place?
Reading • 10 min

✓ Claude Monet. Water Lilies. 1914-26
Video • 1 min

✓ Practical Scenario
Real-world application • 5 min

✓ Emeka Ogboh. Lagos State of Mind. 2017/2020
Video • 2 min

Reimagining a Place

○ **How do artists reimagine architecture?**
Reading • 10 min

○ Teddy Cruz, Fonna Forman. Manufactured Sites: A Housing Urbanism Made of Waste/Maquiladora, project (Model, 2005). 2005-2008
Video • 2 min

○ Carolina Caycedo. Spirals for Shared Dreams. 2022
Video • 4 min

Review & Reflect

○ Optional Readings & Resources
Reading • 10 min

○ Assessment: Places & Spaces
Dialogue • 15 min

○ Optional Prompts for Discussion & Reflection
Reading • 10 min

Module 3
Art & Identity

Module 4
Transforming Everyday Objects

Module 5
Module 5: Art & Society

Module 6
Course Conclusion

How do artists reimagine architecture?

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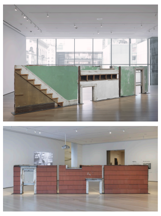
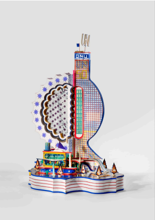


Gordon Matta-Clark. *Bingo*. 1974. Building fragments: painted wood, metal, plaster, and glass, three sections, overall 69" x 25' 7" x 10" (175.3 x 779.8 x 25.4 cm). The Museum of Modern Art, New York. Nina and Gordon Bunshaft Bequest Fund, Nelson A. Rockefeller Bequest Fund, and the Enid A. Haupt Fund. © 2016 Estate of Gordon Matta-Clark/Artists Rights Society (ARS), New York

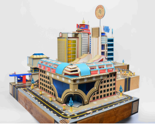
Bingo/Ninths (1974) - Gordon Matta-Clark
Bahhumbug

Watch on

Gordon Matta-Clark used his training in architecture to dismantle buildings and transform them into works of art. Once thriving, by the 1970s Niagara Falls, New York was economically depressed due to the relocation of many industrial plants. The city planning commission allotted Matta-Clark ten days to carve up a condemned house at 349 Erie Avenue before it was demolished. With a small team of workers, he cut the house's northern façade into nine equally sized rectangles so that it resembled a bingo game card, after which this work is titled. The result was eight separate building fragments (MoMA's *Bingo* comprises three of them) and a Super 8 film documenting the deconstruction.



Bodys Isek Kingelez. *U.N.* 1995. Colored paper, paperboard, plastic, aluminum foil, metallic foil paper, foamcore, pencil, crayon, marker, adhesive, colored tape, metallic tape, fabric, copper wire, toothpicks, map pins, metal pins, and plastic bottle caps. 35 13/16 × 29 1/8 × 20 7/8" (91 × 74 × 53 cm), irreg. The Jean Pigozzi African Art Collection. Gift of Jean Pigozzi



Bodys Isek Kingelez. *Kimbembele Ihunga (Kimbembele Ville)*. 1992. Paper, paperboard, plastic, and other various materials, 20 1/16 × 42 1/2 × 34 1/16" (51 × 108 × 88.5 cm). Courtesy The Museum of Everything

Born in the agricultural village of Kimbembele Ihunga in the Belgian Congo (now the Democratic Republic of the Congo) in 1948, Bodys Isek Kingelez came of age in a period of enormous political and social transformation. In 1970, he relocated to Kinshasa, the capital of the newly independent nation renamed Zaire to pursue a university education. He soon became "obsessed with the idea of getting my hands on some scissors, a Gillette razor, and some glue and paper…" and began to create sculptures that took the form of buildings, all constructed from paper, cardboard, and repurposed commercial packaging, and embellished with push-pins, straws, elaborate hand-applied designs, and more.

From the outset, Kingelez focused on the public good—it was through these sculptures that he felt he could help shape "a better, more peaceful world." His early sculptures consist mostly of individual structures that fulfill various civic needs, including municipal buildings, public monuments, and national pavilions. Kingelez often related his work to current events; he made *U.N.* in commemoration of the 50th anniversary of the United Nations, reflecting his belief in a world of democracy, peace, and cooperation.

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